

TRADESFLOW

Field Service Operating System for Trades Businesses

Business Overview & White Paper

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Executive Summary

TradesFlow is a comprehensive cloud-based operating system purpose-built for the trades industry. It unifies job management, fleet coordination, van inventory tracking, automated invoicing, customer communication, AI assistance, financial management, and subscription-based service plans into a single integrated platform.

The platform targets plumbers, electricians, heating engineers, HVAC contractors, and general maintenance providers — businesses that currently rely on fragmented tools, spreadsheets, and manual processes to run their daily operations. TradesFlow replaces this complexity with a modern, intelligent system that reduces administrative burden, increases operational efficiency, and creates new recurring revenue streams.

This white paper outlines the problem the platform solves, its core architecture, key features, commercial model, and long-term strategic vision.

The Industry Problem

Trades businesses in the UK collectively generate billions of pounds in annual revenue, yet the vast majority continue to operate with the same fragmented, inefficient processes they have used for decades. Despite the growth of digital tools in almost every other sector, the trades industry has been slow to adopt integrated technology.

Key Operational Pain Points

- Disorganised job scheduling leading to missed appointments and poor resource use
- No real-time visibility over technician locations or workload
- Poor inventory tracking inside service vehicles, causing lost materials and wasted spend
- Manual invoicing processes that are slow, error-prone, and inconsistent
- Delayed or absent customer communication reducing satisfaction and repeat business
- No centralised financial data, making accounting and VAT compliance difficult
- Missed opportunities for recurring revenue from existing customers
- Emergency response times that are too slow, causing preventable property damage

On the customer side, homeowners and landlords face difficulty finding reliable tradespeople at short notice, especially during emergencies. A lack of digital infrastructure means that even well-established contractors can appear unreliable simply because they lack the tools to communicate effectively.

Platform Overview

TradesFlow operates through three interconnected applications supported by a shared central database. All data — jobs, inventory, financials, communications — is synchronised in real time across every interface.

Three Core Interfaces

Interface	Key Functions
Company Dashboard	Technician Mobile App
Job & fleet management	Daily schedule & navigation
Financial reports	Van inventory scanning
Staff & vehicle oversight	Estimate & invoice creation
Subscription management	Photo & report upload
Analytics & insights	Customer chat

The Customer Application allows homeowners and landlords to book jobs, track arrival times, approve quotes, pay invoices, and manage service subscriptions — all from a single mobile app.

Job Management System

Every service request follows a clearly defined lifecycle within the platform, ensuring that nothing is lost, delayed, or duplicated. The complete job workflow is:

- Lead — Initial enquiry received
- Estimate — Quotation prepared and sent
- Approved — Customer authorises the work
- Scheduled — Technician and time slot assigned
- Work in Progress — Active job underway
- Completed — Work confirmed finished on site
- Invoice Sent — Customer receives billing
- Payment Received — Transaction recorded
- Warranty / Follow-up — Post-job support window

Jobs can be created through multiple channels: the customer app, the office dashboard, telephone entry by admin staff, AI assistant interaction, or future email parsing integration. Each job record stores full details including customer information, property address, assigned technician, materials used, photos, notes, estimate values, and payment status.

Fleet and Technician Management

TradesFlow provides live visibility across the entire fleet. Managers can view a real-time map showing every technician's location and current job status. Each vehicle profile contains the assigned technician, GPS coordinates, today's job schedule, inventory contents, and complete job history.

This visibility transforms how managers respond to incoming work. When a new emergency job arrives, the system can immediately identify the nearest available technician who carries the required materials — and surface that recommendation automatically.

Intelligent Job Allocation

The scheduling engine evaluates multiple factors simultaneously when recommending a technician for each new job:

- Proximity of the technician to the job location
- Current traffic conditions and estimated travel time
- Remaining working hours in the technician's shift
- Required skills, certifications, or Gas Safe registration
- Availability of required materials already loaded in the van

Example Scenario

- A burst pipe emergency is reported in Carlisle at 14:30
- Three technicians are within range — the system evaluates all three
- Technician 2 is closest, has 3 hours remaining, and carries the required fittings
- The system recommends Technician 2 — manager confirms with a single tap
- Customer receives an ETA notification automatically

Van Inventory Management

One of the defining features of TradesFlow is its granular, van-level inventory system. Each vehicle is configured with a virtual rack layout that mirrors its physical storage arrangement. Every shelf slot contains named items with full stock attributes: item name, SKU, quantity, supplier, cost price, and barcode.

Barcode Scanning

Technicians use their smartphone camera to scan items when they are removed from the van during a job. The system instantly deducts the quantity from van inventory, attaches the item to the job record, and adds the cost to the invoice automatically. This eliminates manual materials tracking and prevents stock losses.

Predictive Restocking

As the platform accumulates usage data, it learns which materials are consumed most frequently across each vehicle and job type. Managers receive proactive alerts when stock is predicted to run low within a defined threshold, enabling restocking before shortages affect service delivery.

Supplier Integration

TradesFlow is designed to connect with major trade suppliers including Screwfix, Toolstation, City Plumbing, and Wolseley. Low-stock alerts can trigger direct reorder requests through the platform. A future development phase will introduce supplier price comparison, enabling managers to select the most cost-effective source for each item.

Customer Experience

The customer application gives homeowners and landlords a transparent, professional experience at every stage of a job. Key functions available through the customer app include:

- Job booking with problem description and photo or video upload
- Live technician tracking and estimated arrival time
- Real-time chat with the assigned technician
- Digital quote approval — no phone calls or paperwork required
- Automated invoice receipt with itemised breakdown
- Secure in-app payment
- Full service history for every property
- Subscription plan management

This level of digital interaction significantly reduces inbound phone calls for contractors, improves customer satisfaction, and creates a differentiated service experience that supports retention and referrals.

AI Assistant Integration

TradesFlow includes an embedded AI assistant capable of handling routine customer interactions and internal scheduling tasks without manual staff intervention.

- Responds to common customer enquiries 24 hours a day
- Collects job information, categorises requests, and suggests appointment slots
- Requests photos or videos from customers to pre-assess issues remotely
- Escalates complex or urgent requests to human staff with a full summary
- Assists managers with scheduling recommendations and operational queries

The AI layer reduces response times, extends the company's effective operating hours, and ensures that customer enquiries are never missed — even outside of normal working hours.

Customer Subscription Plans

TradesFlow introduces a subscription model that allows contractors to offer structured service protection plans to their residential and commercial customers. This creates a reliable, predictable income stream alongside standard job revenue.

Example Annual Plan — HomeGuard Protection

- Price: from £199 to £249 per year (or approximately £20 per month)
- Guaranteed response within 12 hours of an emergency call
- Priority booking over non-subscriber customers
- Discounted labour rates on all completed work
- Annual inspection included (e.g. GasCheck boiler service)

- Digital property maintenance record maintained automatically
- Emergency call-out protection with no additional call-out charge

Subscription plans are managed entirely within the platform, including enrolment, renewal, billing, and entitlement tracking. Customers can view and manage their subscription through the mobile app.

Insurance Industry Opportunity

The subscription model has a strategic dimension beyond direct revenue. A property protected by a guaranteed-response service plan is at materially lower risk of severe damage from events such as burst pipes, boiler failures, or electrical faults — because issues are addressed rapidly rather than left until they escalate.

This risk profile is of direct interest to home insurance providers. TradesFlow is positioned to develop partnerships with insurers who may consider reduced premiums or enhanced policy terms for customers who maintain an active TradesFlow protection subscription with a verified contractor.

This creates a three-way value proposition: the homeowner pays less for insurance, the contractor gains a steady subscriber base, and the insurer reduces claims exposure through faster first response.

Financial Automation and Accounting

TradesFlow significantly reduces the administrative burden associated with financial management. The platform automates the creation of financial records at every operational trigger point:

- Completed jobs automatically generate a compliant invoice including labour, materials, and VAT
- Materials deducted from van inventory are logged as job expenses
- Technicians can photograph supplier receipts which are processed by AI to extract and categorise cost data
- Payments received are instantly recorded against the correct invoice
- VAT is calculated and tracked in real time across all transactions

Making Tax Digital Compliance

The platform is designed to maintain a live VAT balance and produce quarterly VAT returns in compliance with HMRC Making Tax Digital requirements. Profit and loss reports, expense summaries, and transaction histories can be exported for accountants or submitted directly via HMRC integration — significantly reducing the cost and effort of year-end accounting.

Digital Property Maintenance Records

Every property serviced through TradesFlow accumulates a permanent digital maintenance record. This log captures all work completed, parts installed, inspection outcomes, and compliance certificates — including Gas Safe records, electrical installation reports, and warranty documentation.

These records provide significant value to property owners and landlords who need to demonstrate maintenance history for insurance purposes, tenancy compliance, or property sale. A comprehensive digital service history may support higher property valuations and reduce friction in the conveyancing process.

Business Analytics and Reporting

The management dashboard provides contractors with a clear, real-time view of their operational and financial performance. Key metrics available include:

- Revenue performance by day, week, month, and year
- Jobs completed per technician with efficiency scoring
- Inventory consumption trends by van and by job type
- Customer subscription growth and renewal rates
- Fleet productivity and mileage tracking
- Outstanding invoice values and payment timelines
- Emergency response performance against subscription SLA targets

These insights allow business owners to make data-driven decisions about staffing, stock purchasing, pricing, and service area expansion.

Technology Architecture

TradesFlow is built on a modern cloud-native architecture designed to scale from a single-van operator to a multi-branch regional contractor without changes to the core platform.

- Cloud-hosted with real-time synchronisation across all interfaces
- Native mobile applications for iOS and Android (technician and customer apps)
- Web-based management dashboard accessible from any browser
- REST API infrastructure enabling third-party integrations
- Barcode and QR scanning via smartphone camera — no additional hardware required
- GPS fleet tracking integrated within the technician mobile application
- AI assistant layer for customer communication and scheduling support
- HMRC-compatible financial data export and Making Tax Digital integration

Long-Term Vision

The long-term strategic ambition for TradesFlow extends beyond being a business management tool. As the platform grows its contractor network, it will be positioned to evolve into a national trades services marketplace.

National Network Vision

- Customers request a service directly through the TradesFlow platform
- The system identifies the nearest available verified contractor in the network
- The job is dispatched automatically — the customer is notified with an ETA
- The contractor manages the job through their existing TradesFlow interface
- All billing, communication, and records are handled within the platform

This model creates a national service ecosystem for skilled trades — comparable in structure to modern ride-hailing or delivery platforms, but operating within the regulated, skilled trades sector. Contractors gain access to a broader customer base. Customers gain faster access to verified, professional tradespeople. TradesFlow earns a platform fee on marketplace transactions.

The foundation for this national network is built from day one: every job, every technician profile, every van inventory record, and every customer interaction is already stored in a centralised, structured database designed to scale.

Commercial Model

TradesFlow is offered on a SaaS (Software as a Service) subscription model, giving contractors access to the full platform for a predictable monthly fee based on the size of their operation.

Starter Plan	Professional Plan
Starter	Professional
Up to 3 technicians	Up to 15 technicians
Job management	Full inventory management
Customer app	AI assistant
Basic invoicing	Financial automation
Email support	Priority support

An Enterprise tier is available for larger regional contractors and multi-branch operations, with custom pricing, dedicated onboarding, and API access for integration with existing systems. Additional revenue is generated through the marketplace transaction fee as the national network develops.

Conclusion

TradesFlow addresses a clear and persistent gap in the trades industry: the absence of a single, integrated digital platform that covers every aspect of running a trades business — from the first customer enquiry to the final payment and beyond.

By combining job management, fleet tracking, van inventory, customer communication, AI assistance, subscription services, and financial automation into one coherent system, TradesFlow gives contractors the tools they need to operate more efficiently, serve customers more effectively, and build more sustainable, scalable businesses.

The subscription model introduces recurring revenue that makes contractor income more predictable. The insurance partnership opportunity creates a compelling value proposition for homeowners. And the long-term national marketplace vision provides a clear path to building something genuinely transformative in a sector that is overdue for digital change.

TradesFlow is ready to build.

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